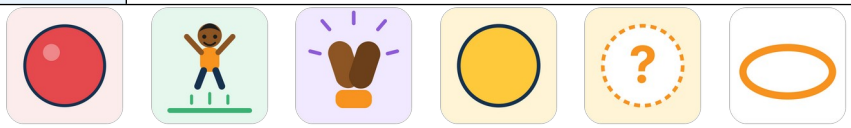
02 · Lesson spec

Practice & Play: Pattern Games · 40 minutes · game rotation in groups of 4–6 · fully unplugged · no new concept

Goal	**I can play pattern games and say what comes next.**
Core parts	Move + Code
Key words	pattern · repeat · next · shape · sort · rule
Materials	Six station signs (Printables); card sets from Weeks 1–6; gap pattern strips (Printables); the W4 shape track; 2–3 hoops and big objects; large card counters; class observation checklist (Guide 05)



1. Watch (5 min)

- **Say:** “It’s game week! We are playing all our pattern games again.” Show each station sign and do one quick example.
- **Ask:** “Which pattern game do you like best?” Take a few answers.
- Rule: “At each station, everyone continues a pattern.” Two claps mean “move to the next station”.

2. Game rotation (25 min)

Station	Replays	What children do
A · Pattern Line	Week 1	Children stand in a red, blue, red, blue line. The next child joins in the right colour.
B · Robot Dance	Week 2	Copy a dance pattern (jump, clap, jump, clap), then continue it.
C · Clap Back	Week 3	A leader claps and stamps a pattern; the group claps it back and keeps it going.
D · Pattern Hop	Week 4	Hop along the shape track saying the shapes; say which shape comes next.
E · Freeze and Guess + Card challenge (teacher)	Week 5	The robot freezes: guess the next move. Then a partner lays a 4-card AB pattern with a gap; fill the gap and add 2 more; swap.
F · Sorting Robots	Week 6	Carry big objects to the hoops by one rule; say the rule.

- Six stations, about **4 minutes each**. Groups of 4–6 rotate on two claps.
- **The teacher stays at Station E** (Freeze and Guess + Card challenge, Core: Code) and works with children who need more help with continuing patterns.
- Stations A, B, C and D are **Core: Move** games. A helper or a confident child can lead them.
- Big class? Run two copies of Stations A and C, or play 3 stations today and 3 in Week 8.
- **Stretch** at Station E: spot and fix the mistake in a pattern strip.

3. Share (10 min)

Activity Book page (4 min): colour what comes next. Not marked.

- **Ask:** “Which game was your favourite? What came next?”
- **Create** (if time allows): draw your favourite pattern game.
- **Close:** say the Term 2 words with their hand signs: pattern, repeat, next, shape, sort, rule.

Common mistakes

- Continuing with any card (red, blue, green) → “Say it out loud: red, blue, red, blue… what comes next?”
- At the card challenge, adding 2 cards but leaving the gap empty → “First the gap, then 2 more.”
- Changing the rule halfway at Sorting Robots → “What is our rule?”

What if it doesn’t work?

- Rotation is too noisy or slow → run 3 stations today and 3 next week, or play one game at a time as a whole class.
- Missing cards → use claps, stamps and children’s bodies; every game works without cards.

Support and stretch

- **Support:** at the teacher’s station, start with a 2-card pattern and say it together before adding.
- **Stretch** (optional, never assessed): spot and fix the mistake in a pattern strip.

How we check

Observation only. Use the class checklist (Guide 05): copies and continues an AB pattern; says what comes next; sorts by one rule.

> **Safety**
> Large objects and card counters only (nothing smaller than a toilet-roll tube opening). Count pieces in and out. Walk between stations.